ADEXPRESS CLASSIFIEDS WEEKLY

Website Setup Guide

Everything you need to take this website live, step by step. No prior technical experience assumed.

Follow the parts in order. Nothing in this guide costs money — the only recurring bill is your domain name.

Part 0 — What you are signing up for

Service	What it does for you	Cost	Card needed?
GitHub	Stores the website code	Free	No
Supabase	Database + your admin login	Free	No
Cloudflare R2	Stores the PDFs and banner images	Free up to 10 GB	**Yes** — but you are not charged inside the free limits
Vercel	Runs the website	Free	No
Web3Forms *(optional)*	Emails you a copy of each enquiry	Free	No
Your domain registrar	Your web address	~Rs.800–1,200/year	Yes

> **About the Cloudflare card.** R2 asks for a card even on the free plan. It is the one service worth it: R2 never charges for downloads, so if one issue goes viral your bill stays at zero. Every other storage option charges per download.
>
> **You can skip R2 at first.** Leave those settings blank and the site uses Supabase Storage instead. That works fine, but the free plan allows only about 5 GB of downloads a month — roughly 300 downloads of a 15 MB paper. Add R2 the moment you outgrow it.

Part 1 — Put the code on GitHub

1. Create a free account at **github.com**.
2. Click **+** (top right) -> **New repository**.
3. Name it `adexpress-website`. Choose **Private**. Click **Create repository**.
4. On your computer, open Terminal in the project folder and run:

```
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Initial website"
git branch -M main
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/adexpress-website.git
git push -u origin main
```

Replace `YOUR-USERNAME` with your GitHub username.

Part 2 — Supabase (database + admin login)

2.1 Create the project

1. Go to **supabase.com** -> **Start your project** -> sign in with GitHub.
2. **New project**.
   - **Name:** `adexpress`
   - **Database password:** click Generate, then **save it somewhere safe**
   - **Region:** pick the one closest to your readers (e.g. Mumbai / Singapore)
3. Wait about two minutes for it to finish setting up.

2.2 Create the tables

1. In the left sidebar click **SQL Editor** -> **New query**.
2. Open the file `supabase/schema.sql` from the project folder.
3. Copy **all** of it, paste it into the editor, click **RUN**.
4. You should see *Success. No rows returned*. That is correct.

2.3 Create your admin login

Signing in uses a six-digit code emailed to you — there is no password to

choose, lose or leak.

1. Left sidebar -> **Authentication** -> **Users** -> **Add user** -> **Create new user**.
2. Enter the email address you will sign in with.
3. Tick **Auto Confirm User**, then create.
4. Left sidebar -> **Authentication** -> **Providers** -> **Email**: make sure

Enable email provider is on.

5. Left sidebar -> **Authentication** -> **Sign In / Providers**: turn

Allow new users to sign up off.

> Step 5 matters. The login page asks Supabase for a code with `shouldCreateUser: false`, so only addresses you have added here can ever request one. With sign-ups disabled as well, nobody can create an account from the outside even if that setting is changed later.
>
> Anyone listed under **Users** has full admin access, so add only people who should be able to publish.

2.4 Copy your three keys

Left sidebar -> **Project Settings** -> **API** (or **Data API**).

Copy this	Into this `.env.local` line
Project URL	`NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL`

Copy this	Into this .env.local line
anon / publishable key	NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY
service_role / secret key	SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY

> The **service_role** key is a master key to your database. Never put it in a message, a screenshot, or any file that starts with `NEXT_PUBLIC_`.

Part 3 — Vercel (putting the site online)

1. Go to **vercel.com** -> **Sign up** -> **Continue with GitHub**.
2. **Add New... -> Project** -> find `adexpress-website` -> **Import**.
3. Before clicking Deploy, open **Environment Variables** and add each line from your `.env.local` (name on the left, value on the right).
   - For `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL`, use `https://YOUR-PROJECT.vercel.app` for now. You will change it to your real domain in Part 5.
4. Click **Deploy** and wait a couple of minutes.
5. Open the URL it gives you. The site is live.
6. Go to `your-url/admin`, sign in with the account from step 2.3, and upload a test PDF to confirm everything works.

> **A note on Vercel's free plan.** Vercel's terms reserve the Hobby (free) plan for non-commercial use, and a paper that sells advertising is commercial. In practice small sites run on it without trouble, but if you want to be strictly correct, **Netlify** and **Cloudflare Pages** both allow commercial use on their free tiers and deploy this same code. Import the same GitHub repository there instead — the environment variables are identical.

Part 4 — Cloudflare R2 (recommended, do this within the first month)

4.1 Create the bucket

1. Go to **cloudflare.com** -> sign up -> **R2 Object Storage** in the sidebar.
2. Add a payment card when asked. You will not be charged within the free limits.
3. **Create bucket** -> name it `adexpress-media` -> **Create**.

4.2 Make the bucket readable by the public

1. Open the bucket -> **Settings** tab -> **Public access**.
2. Either:
   - **Custom domain** (better): add `media.YOUR-DOMAIN.com`. Cloudflare sets up the DNS for you if your domain is on Cloudflare. Your public URL is then `https://media.YOUR-DOMAIN.com`.
   - **or R2.dev subdomain**: click **Allow Access**. Your public URL is the `https://pub-xxxxxxxx.r2.dev` address it shows you.
3. Save whichever URL you ended up with.

4.3 Allow uploads from your website

Still in **Settings**, find **CORS policy** -> **Edit** -> paste this, replacing the domain with yours:

```
[
  {
    "AllowedOrigins": [
      "http://localhost:3000",
      "https://YOUR-DOMAIN.com",
      "https://YOUR-PROJECT.vercel.app"
    ],
    "AllowedMethods": ["GET", "PUT", "HEAD"],
    "AllowedHeaders": ["*"],
    "ExposeHeaders": ["ETag"],
    "MaxAgeSeconds": 3600
  }
]
```

(The same text is in `cors-r2.json` in the project folder.)

> If uploads fail in the admin dashboard with a network error, it is almost always this step. Check the domain here matches your site exactly.

4.4 Create API keys

1. R2 overview page -> **Manage R2 API Tokens** -> **Create API token**.
2. Permissions: **Object Read & Write**. Scope it to your bucket. Create.
3. Copy the three values it shows you **now** — the secret is shown only once.

Copy this	Into this `.env.local` line
Account ID (top right of the R2 page)	`R2_ACCOUNT_ID`

Copy this	Into this `.env.local` line
Access Key ID	`R2_ACCESS_KEY_ID`
Secret Access Key	`R2_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY`
`adexpress-media`	`R2_BUCKET_NAME`
The public URL from step 4.2	`NEXT_PUBLIC_R2_PUBLIC_URL`

4. Add all five to Vercel -> your project -> **Settings -> Environment Variables**, then **Deployments -> ... -> Redeploy**.

Part 5 — Your domain

1. Buy a domain anywhere (GoDaddy, Namecheap, Cloudflare, BigRock...).
2. In Vercel: **Settings -> Domains -> Add** -> type your domain.
3. Vercel shows you the DNS records to create. Add them at your registrar:
   - `A` record, name `@`, value `76.76.21.21`
   - `CNAME` record, name `www`, value `cname.vercel-dns.com`
4. Wait for it to verify (usually minutes, sometimes a few hours).
5. Update `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL` in Vercel to `https://your-domain.com` and redeploy. **This matters for Google** — it is what the sitemap uses.

Part 6 — Keep the database awake (2 minutes, important)

Supabase pauses a free project after **7 days with no activity**. If that happens your site goes down until you log in and resume it. The project already contains a job that prevents this — you just need to give it the keys.

1. On GitHub, open your repository -> **Settings** -> **Secrets and variables** -> **Actions** -> **New repository secret**.
2. Add two secrets:
   - `SUPABASE_URL` — your Supabase project URL
   - `SUPABASE_ANON_KEY` — your anon key
3. Go to the **Actions** tab -> **Keep Supabase awake** -> **Run workflow** to test it once. From then on it runs by itself every five days.

Part 7 — Email copies of enquiries (optional)

Every enquiry is already saved and visible at `/admin/enquiries`. This step just also sends them to your inbox.

1. Go to **web3forms.com**, enter your email, get an access key emailed to you.
2. Add it to Vercel as `WEB3FORMS_ACCESS_KEY` and redeploy.

Free plan: 250 enquiries a month.

Part 8 — Make the site yours

Open `site.config.ts` in the project. Everything the visitor reads is here:

- `name`, `legalName`, `tagline` — your paper's name
- `since` — the year you started
- `contact` — phone, WhatsApp number, email, address, office hours
- `social` — leave a line empty to hide that icon
- `editions` — the editions you publish. **The `slug` is used in the database, so once you have published issues, do not change existing slugs.**
- `stats` — the four numbers on the home page
- `process` — the "How we work" steps
- `categories` — the ad categories listed on the Advertise page

Save, commit, push — Vercel redeploys automatically:

```
git add .
git commit -m "Update site details"
git push
```

To change the colours, edit the `@theme` block at the top of `app/globals.css`.

Part 9 — Google (SEO)

The site already produces `sitemap.xml`, `robots.txt`, page titles, descriptions and structured data. To finish:

1. Go to **search.google.com/search-console** -> **Add property** -> **URL prefix** -> your domain.
2. Verify it (the **DNS record** method is easiest).
3. **Sitemaps** -> submit `sitemap.xml`.

4. Add your business on **Google Business Profile** too — for a local paper this brings more traffic than anything else.

Give it one to two weeks to appear in results.

Publishing an issue each week

1. Go to `your-domain.com/admin` and sign in.
2. **Publish** in the top menu.
3. Drag this week's PDF onto the box.
4. Fill in the title, choose the edition, check the date.
5. Click **Publish this issue**.

The cover picture and page count are worked out for you. The issue appears on the site within about a minute.

Keep PDFs under about 25 MB. Readers on mobile data will thank you, and you will fit far more issues in free storage. If your PDF is bigger, compress it — `ilovepdf.com/compress_pdf` is free and works well.

Adding a sponsor banner

1. `/admin` -> **Banners**.
2. Upload the advertiser's image, enter their name and the link.
3. Choose where it appears:

Placement	Suggested image size
Home — below hero	1200 × 200 px
Home — mid page	1200 × 250 px
Archive — between issues	1200 × 200 px
Reader — beside the PDF	600 × 500 px
Every page — above footer	1200 × 200 px

4. Optionally set an end date, then **Add banner**.

Views and clicks for each banner are shown on that page, so you have real numbers to show the advertiser at renewal time.

If something goes wrong

Problem	What to do
Upload fails with a network error	R2 CORS (step 4.3). Check the domain matches exactly.
Site says it can't connect to the database	Supabase project is paused — open supabase.com and click Resume. Then do Part 6.
No sign-in code arrives	Check the address exists under Supabase -> Authentication -> Users, and that the email provider is enabled. Codes expire after a few minutes — request a new one.
New issue doesn't appear	Wait one minute and refresh — pages cache for 60 seconds. Also check it isn't saved as a Draft.
PDF won't open in the reader	Confirm the PDF opens normally on your computer, and that the bucket's public access is on (step 4.2).
Enquiry emails not arriving	Check `WEB3FORMS_ACCESS_KEY` in Vercel, and your spam folder. The enquiry is still saved in `/admin/enquiries` either way.

Your `.env.local` checklist

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL=              <- Part 5
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL=          <- Part 2.4
NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY=     <- Part 2.4
SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY=         <- Part 2.4  (secret!)
R2_ACCOUNT_ID=                     <- Part 4.4
R2_ACCESS_KEY_ID=                  <- Part 4.4
R2_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY=              <- Part 4.4  (secret!)
R2_BUCKET_NAME=adexpress-media     <- Part 4.1
NEXT_PUBLIC_R2_PUBLIC_URL=         <- Part 4.2
WEB3FORMS_ACCESS_KEY=              <- Part 7 (optional)
```

The same values must also be added in Vercel under **Settings -> Environment Variables**. `.env.local` is only used on your own computer, and is deliberately never uploaded to GitHub.

Appendix — Before you start: install Node.js

To run or build the site on your own computer you need **Node.js 20 or newer**.

1. Go to **nodejs.org** and download the **LTS** version for your operating system.

2. Install it, then open Terminal (macOS) or Command Prompt (Windows) and check:

```
node --version
```

You should see something like `v22.20.0`. Then, in the project folder:

```
npm install
npm run dev
```

You do **not** need Node.js installed to run the live website — Vercel, Netlify and Cloudflare install it for you when they build. It is only needed if you want to preview changes on your own machine first.